

City of Medford

FY26 Community Preservation Act

Tufts Park Garden Expansion

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY FOR CITY COUNCIL
APRIL 28, 2026



Dear City Council,

This executive summary provides an overview of a FY26 Community Preservation Act (“CPA”) funding recommendation made by the Community Preservation Committee (“CPC”) for the Medford City Council to consider.

This recommendation took into consideration public feedback received at community outreach events/surveys and priorities of City leadership, was informed by the City’s Open Space and Recreation Plan, as well as our Comprehensive Plan. This information is intended to provide additional detail of the project and its community impact.

We thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully submitted,

Theresa Dupont
Community Preservation Act Manager

Project: Tufts Park Community Garden Expansion

Funding Recommendation: \$4,000

Applicant: Medford Community Garden Commission

CPA Category: Open Space/Recreation

[Link to application materials here](#) or by visiting medfordma.org/boards-commissions/community-preservation-committee and selecting ‘FY26 Applications Under Consideration’

Project Summary:

To expand the existing community garden to include 10 new planting beds. In 2025, the Tufts Park basketball courts were redone, which created a narrow strip of unutilized land between the courts and existing community garden. This project will extend the existing fence to incorporate this unused strip into the garden space, as well as purchase the new, corrugated steel planting beds and bring the total bed count to 31.

Objectives:

- Continue to provide outdoor recreational space to a growing number of residents who are requesting community garden amenities.

Key Outcomes:

- Reduce the amount of residents on community garden waitlist (150+ people)
- Increase awareness and education of home gardening

CPC Funding conditions

1. Funding is conditioned upon the Medford Community Garden Commission receiving approval from the Medford Parks Commission on the garden expansion prior to any work commencing
 - a. *Note that the Parks Commission approved the expansion at their April 21, 2026 meeting*